[14 Oct 2026 Updated]

PROJECT CONCEPT NOTE

Remarks: Complete this document before printing, then submit to the lecturer for review.

Basic information	Complete the fields below
Project title	Community Volunteer Support and Digital System Improvement Project
Group name	Group D
Academic Year/Semester	2026C
Project leader	Name: Tong Ming Hui Student ID: B260082A
Group members	1. Lou Hong Ee ID: B260005A 2. Er Jun Hong ID: B260043A 3. Chok Yun Ying ID: B260103A 4. Lok Wen Xin ID: B260073A 5. Tan Soon Ci ID: B260087A
Proposed community/beneficiaries	Individuals and families in need of food assistance
Potential community partner	Organization: 448 Foodbank Johor Contact Person: Tee Tiam Yong Contact Number: +60162417448 Website (if any): https://www.foodbank448.org/

A. Community need

1. What needs or issues do you think the community is experiencing? Be specific.

Response:

448 Food Bank Johor is experiencing administrative difficulties, including managing donor and volunteer information, preparing e-certificates, and notifying registrants. Relying on manual data entry and emailing means the food bank needs to spend a lot of time. It is quite easy for mistakes to occur, duplication of information, and even delays in the preparation of certificates. Applicants will keep submitting their applications over and over again since they have not received any response. All this repetitive work makes it difficult for the administrators to spend more time on the main work of collecting, packing, and distributing food. The introduction of an automated system will therefore be useful in improving performance.

2. How did you identify this need? What information or preliminary evidence supports it?

Response:

The need for such a system was derived from an interview conducted with a representative of the 448 Food Bank. The representative revealed some of the problems being experienced by them in preparing e-certificates, maintaining donor and volunteer data, and sending notifications. From the feedback received, we found out that there were repetitive tasks that needed automation. Hence, our team recommended a donation and volunteer automation system that would involve the use of Excel, Word, and PDF certificate creation, Google Forms, Google Sheets, automatic email notifications, and information sharing using WhatsApp.

3. What do you still need to ask or verify with the community or partner?

Response:

Before starting the implementation process, our team must get certain important information verified by the food bank to make sure that the development of the Donation and Volunteer Automation System will meet the organization's needs. Firstly, we have to clarify what kind of information is needed for the donor and volunteer registration forms and appreciation certificates, including names, dates, and others. Secondly, we need to understand the communication preferences of the food banks. Do the food banks prefer to communicate via email, WhatsApp, or have automatic notifications sent through both channels. Thirdly, we have to clarify what technical resources we can use, what access rights we should have, and how the personal information should be protected. Last, it is essential to evaluate the skill of the representative in digital technology to make sure that they can operate the new system.

B. Initial project idea

4. What would your group like to do, and how might it respond to the identified need?

Proposed activity and rationale:

We are going to create a Donation and Volunteer Automation System for 448 Foodbank Johor. Excel will be used to keep track of donor and volunteer information, and thank-you certificates will be automatically produced using a Word template. The certificates will be available in Word and PDF format and can be shared via WhatsApp. In addition, we plan to use Google Forms to collect volunteer registrations and Google Sheets to record the responses. A Python program will automatically check Google Sheets for new registrations, and email notifications will be sent out. The overall goal of this system is to provide the following benefits: to minimize manual labor, to streamline the record-keeping process, and to simplify the management of donation and volunteer activities.

5. Who may benefit, and what benefit do you hope to support?

Target beneficiaries and intended benefit:

The main beneficiaries will be 448 Foodbank Johor and its staff or organisers, donors, and volunteers. The system can assist the organisation in saving time when creating thank-you certificates and handling volunteer registration. Certificates will be available for all donors to recognise their donations, and email notifications can be sent to volunteers to provide details about the activities. Overall, the project aims to improve administrative efficiency and assist the organisation in its community activities.

6. Which ONE SDG is most relevant? Explain the connection.

Primary SDG and explanation:

Primary SDG: SDG 17 – Partnerships for the Goals

Our project contributes to SDG 17 by improving communication between 448 Foodbank Johor and donors as well as volunteers. The automated certificate and registration processes can help motivate participation and foster cooperation between the organisation, donors, and volunteers. These efforts can contribute to building partnerships to support community work.

7. What could make the project difficult, unsafe or inappropriate? What would you need to check?

Initial risks/questions:

A potential problem is that the system could be down or not working when creating certificates or sending email notifications. Donor or volunteer information may also be incorrect, which can lead to mistakes. Also, names, phone numbers and email addresses should be treated with care to ensure privacy. Before implementation, the system needs to be tested by our group, permission to use the data has to be obtained from the organisation, and the system requirements need to be confirmed. It is also important to assess whether suitable devices, internet access and staff are available within the organisation to use the system. The system should only be implemented with the organisation's approval.

C. Initial feasibility

☑ The project responds to a plausible community need, not only to our group's interests.

☑ The proposed activity appears achievable within the course timeline.

☑ We have identified a potential community partner or a clear way to approach one.

☑ We have considered likely costs, transport, materials and safety.

☑ We understand that the project needs lecturer approval before implementation.

Group Leader	Date	Lecturer review
Signature: Name: Tong Ming Hui	29/10/2026	☐ Proceed to partner consultation and proposal ☐ Revise concept note ☐ Do not proceed
Lecturer's comments:		